MICHAEL BASSEY

Cybersecurity Engineer | Penetration Tester | DevSecOps

Abuja, Nigeria (Open to Remote) • +234 906 443 0309 • michaelbassey808@gmail.com • linkedin.com/in/michael-bassey

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Security Engineer with 3+ years of hands-on experience across Application security, Network security, API Security, IT security, and Vulnerability Assessment and Penetration Testing (VAPT). Remediated 50+ vulnerabilities and cut client attack surface by 40% across web applications, APIs, and cloud infrastructure. Applies SAST before release and DAST after deployment, with MITRE ATT&CK, OWASP Top 10, and NIST guiding risk priorities. Growing a DevSecOps practice across GitHub Actions, Terraform, Vault, and AWS.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Offensive Security: Penetration Testing (Web, API, Network, Black-Box), VAPT, Bug Bounty Research, Reconnaissance & Enumeration

Application Security: SAST, DAST, API Security, Threat Modeling (STRIDE), OWASP Top 10, Secure SDLC, Authentication & Access Control (RBAC)

DevSecOps (Junior): CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Terraform, HashiCorp Vault, Staging-Branch Workflow, Secrets & API Key Handling, AWS (EC2), Vercel, Cloudflare

Defensive & Operations: Vulnerability Management, Incident Response, Identity & Access Management, Risk Analysis & Remediation, Linux, Backup & Disaster Recovery, MFA & Endpoint Protection

Frameworks: MITRE ATT&CK, STRIDE, OWASP Top 10, NIST CSF, Zero Trust; ISO 27001 and SOC 2 (foundational)

Tools: Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Metasploit, Nmap, Nessus, Wireshark, SQLMap, Linux, Snort, Terraform, SonarQube, Git, Github actions, Grafana, Kubernetes, Trivy, Gitleaks, Kali Linux, Python, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Engineer September 2025 – Present

DefComm Solutions and Technologies LTD; Abuja FCT Nigeria

- Identified and remediated 50+ vulnerabilities across client web applications, APIs, and cloud infrastructure through application, network, and cloud security assessments.
- Ran VAPT on web applications, APIs, and infrastructure, reducing attack surface by 40%.
- Found authentication, authorization, and data exposure weaknesses in client APIs and worked with developers to fix them.
- Applied SAST before release and DAST after deployment to catch critical flaws before they reach production.
- Launched and managed a bug bounty program with 50+ ethical hackers, handling vulnerability intake, validation, severity assessment, and remediation tracking.
- Apply STRIDE threat modeling to application and API designs to identify spoofing, tampering, repudiation, information disclosure, denial-of-service, and privilege escalation risks at the design stage
- Administered the admin dashboard, controlling access and permissions for 500+ users.
- Verified 100% compliance with security design requirements before client delivery.

Vulnerability Assessment & Penetration Tester September 2024 – June 2025

Silex Secure Labs, Abuja FCT. Nigeria

- Delivered VAPT services for the company's own systems and external client organizations, uncovering 15+ authentication and authorization weaknesses across web applications and APIs.
- Tested RBAC for privilege escalation and horizontal and vertical access bypass.
- Analyzed application logic for input validation flaws and business logic vulnerabilities.
- Maintained network switches, routers, firewalls, and workstations as primary IT support, reducing downtime and security incidents by 30%.
- Enforced MFA, user permissions, and antivirus; safeguarded payment gateway and client data; ran routine backups and disaster recovery tests.
- Performed black-box penetration testing on a client insurance platform, simulating real-world external attacker conditions to uncover vulnerabilities

Bug Bounty Researcher January 2024 – Present

HackerOne

- Practice on private and public HackerOne programs to sharpen offensive skills in real-world conditions, with a focus on learning rather than bounty earnings.
- Run reconnaissance and enumeration with Amass, Shodan, Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, and ffuf to surface hidden endpoints, subdomains, and misconfigured assets.

Cybersecurity & VAPT Intern January 2024 – August 2025

CFSS | The Red Users | Prodigy InfoTech | Hacktify

- Executed penetration tests that uncovered XSS, SQL injection, and authentication and authorization misconfigurations.
- Worked hands-on with Nmap, Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Metasploit, Nikto, Wireshark, SQLMap, and Kali Linux.
- Reviewed encryption and firewall configurations to reduce data exposure risk.
- Kept learning and adapting across rotating internships, picking up new offensive security techniques and tooling at each placement.

DEVOPS & DEVSECOPS

DefComm Solutions and Technologies LTD May 2026 - Present

- Create and manage GitHub repositories, using a staging branch so developer code is reviewed, scanned, and merged without ever touching main.
- Scan third-party dependencies and packages to catch supply chain risk before merge, and enforce security compliance across every repository
- Run SAST/DAST after each deployment, testing the live application the way a penetration test would.
- Build CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions and Terraform, and deploy infrastructure on AWS (EC2), Vercel and Render..
- Deploy applications on Vercel, and manage domains, environment variables, and API keys securely and using HashiCorp Vault for secrets management.

KEY PROJECTS

1. **VulnScanner Platform v2.0:** Built a single-file enterprise scanning platform covering web, network (Nmap), and API scanning, GitHub secrets detection, authenticated browser session recording, and AI-assisted analysis.
2. **Black-Box Penetration Test, Client Insurance Platform (Silex Secure Labs):** Simulated an external attacker with no source code or internal access across reconnaissance, authentication testing, input validation, SSL/TLS analysis, and vulnerability scanning. Findings included username enumeration, missing cookie security flags, session ID exposure, potential SQL injection, and missing CSP. Delivered a full professional report.
3. **API Security Assessment:** Assessed and secured APIs against the OWASP Top 10, covering authentication, authorization, input validation, and data exposure. Identified weaknesses, documented findings with remediation guidance, and worked with developers to fix them.
4. **Secure Development Workflow Architecture:** Designed a mandatory security architecture for all teams: staging branch for every change, required security scans and review, and merges to main only after clearance.
5. **Security Awareness & Phishing Simulation:** Developed and delivered awareness training, phishing simulations, and secure computing guidelines.

SPEAKING & INDUSTRY ENGAGEMENTS

Radio Guest, Cybersecurity Awareness Month October 2026
TALK YOUR OWN, REAL 99.3FM Abuja | Representing DefComm Solutions

- Discussed how AI-generated and manipulated content could influence Nigeria's 2027 general elections.
- Explained how to spot manipulated images and video and which tools verify content, stressing digital literacy, source verification, and checking original media before sharing.

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Genetics and Biotechnology Graduated August 2025
University of Calabar, Nigeria

Ethical Hacking & Penetration Testing Bootcamp 2022 – 2023
Zero to Hero Mastery

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified API Hacking Expert (CAPIE)
- Certified Cybersecurity Educator Professional (CCEP)
- Multicloud Network Associate
- Cloud Security and Audit Fundamentals